Laravel supports a wide range of architectural patterns—from monolithic applications to microservices and serverless deployments. Features like queues, broadcasting, events, and caching allow apps to scale easily.

1.3.4 Security First

Laravel includes out-of-the-box security features like CSRF protection, input validation, password hashing, and rate limiting, ensuring secure application development.

1.3.5 Rich Community and Ecosystem

Laravel has one of the most active and supportive communities in the PHP ecosystem. It also boasts an extensive package ecosystem that covers everything from payment integration to admin panels.

1.3.6 Future-Ready

Laravel aligns closely with modern PHP and web development standards, embracing tools like Composer, PHPUnit, Vite, Docker (via Laravel Sail), and more. It also supports modern API development practices and can be deployed to cloud environments like Laravel Forge or Vapor.

1.4 Installing Laravel 12

Laravel can be installed globally via Composer or by using Laravel Installer. Before you begin, ensure you have **PHP ≥ 8.2**, **Composer**, and a database like **MySQL** installed on your system.

1.4.1 PHP Version

In this book, we will use the latest version of PHP, which is **PHP 8.4** or higher. You can check your PHP version by running:

```
php -v
```

If you have an older version, consider upgrading to take advantage of the latest features and performance improvements.

1.4.2 Using Composer